



How the Nine Aged

A companion to The Independence Illusion

Where the fragility we flagged has shown up since · verified July 2026

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The Independence Illusion read nine semiconductor companies' filed contracts and named, for each, the single dependency most likely to become a problem — a controlling parent, a single foundry, a foreign strategic investor, a change-of-control tripwire. This is a short check on what has happened since.

One caution up front, and it matters: this is correlation, not causation. We did not predict these events, and the contracts did not *cause* them — Intel and Mubadala are selling for their own reasons; onsemi bid for its own reasons. The claim is narrower, and we think more useful: **fragility is where stress lands**. We flagged where each company was structurally exposed; here is where the stress showed up.

Where the tripwire tripped

Allegro — the clause we quoted, triggered. The chapter flagged the exact term: Allegro's key rights unwound if its Japanese parent, Sanken, fell below 50%. In July 2024 Sanken repurchased down from **50.8% to 32.5%** — across that precise line. Decontrol is what put Allegro in play: months later **onsemi bid roughly \$6.9 billion** (\$35.10 a share, a 57% premium); the board rejected it and onsemi withdrew in April 2025. The change-of-control vulnerability we named did not merely persist — it produced the event.

Mobileye — the parent's distress became the overhang. We flagged Intel's ~80% control as the dependency that mattered. In 2025, Intel — in its own cash crisis — **sold Mobileye stock into the market** (about \$900 million, then roughly \$1 billion in July 2025), and the shares fell on the news. That is what "captive to a parent" means in practice: the parent's problems arrive on your cap table, mechanically, whether or not your own quarter was fine.

Cerebras — the exposure we named cost about eighteen months. The chapter flagged G42, the Abu Dhabi group that was both Cerebras's largest customer and an investor, as a national-security exposure. Cerebras's IPO was **postponed from October 2024 pending a CFIUS review of G42's stake**, cleared only in March 2025 after G42 divested its Chinese holdings; the original filing went stale and was withdrawn, and Cerebras **refiled in December 2025 — with G42 no longer listed as an investor** — now targeting a 2026 listing. The precise foreign-strategic-investor exposure, playing out close to script.

Confirmed, live, not blown up

- **GlobalFoundries** — the single-substrate dependency we flagged is now quantified in the open: **about 71% of its SOI wafer spend runs through one supplier, Soitec** — most of its specialty-wafer supply, from one vendor it can't easily replace. Its 81% owner, Mubadala, keeps exercising control — consent rights over large deals, and selling GF down through secondary offerings, the same "sovereign owner as a liquidity source" pattern visible at Mobileye.
- **Everspin — the most telling of all, because the company acted on the exact risk.** Against the single-GlobalFoundries captivity we described, Everspin signed a **ten-year manufacturing agreement**

with Microchip to add US capacity. When the subject of the analysis moves to fix the dependency you flagged, the flag was real.

- **SiTime** — its current annual report still describes the Bosch single-source dependency in the same terms we did, and the **initial Bosch term expires in February 2027** — the exit-and-renewal leverage moment the chapter pointed to is now months away.
- **SkyWater** — doubled down on the model we flagged: it bought a fab funded by a **\$350 million debt facility** and signed a **new multi-year anchor supply agreement** with the seller's affiliate — capacity on leverage plus an anchor commitment, intensified.
- **MetaOptics** — the A*STAR dependency is intact, and the company listed *small* (about S\$6 million in Singapore) while **trimming its US offering by roughly a quarter** — consistent with the "small, everything-licensed" profile the chapter drew. (Aquantia, the ninth, had already been absorbed into Marvell.)

The honest read

On the narrow test of *did stress appear where we said the company was weak* — it did. Three of the nine saw a concrete event on the exact axis we named; the rest are confirmed live, and one, Everspin, is actively repairing the vulnerability. None of this proves a contract caused an outcome, and we are not claiming a forecast. It shows something simpler and more durable: reading the exhibits tells you **where a company will feel pressure** — and pressure, when it comes, tends to arrive exactly there.

Read the exhibits.

Companion to "The Independence Illusion." Events verified against public reporting as of July 2026; every item is public and checkable. Correlation, not causation — nothing here asserts that a contract caused an outcome, and nothing here is investment advice. Sources include company filings and releases (Allegro/GlobeNewswire, onsemi IR, Intel/Mobileye via Times of Israel), SiliconANGLE and Tech Startups (Cerebras/CFIUS), TipRanks (GlobalFoundries/Mubadala), MRAM-Info (Everspin/Microchip), and Renaissance Capital (MetaOptics).